

Two weaknesses stretch a defense

Positional Judgment

THE IDEA

A single weakness can sometimes be defended efficiently. Creating a second target may force the defender to split resources. The targets must be far enough apart or tactically connected so that one defensive setup cannot handle both.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A rook tied to defending a queenside pawn may struggle when your king attacks a kingside pawn. Switching pressure can force a concession, but switching too slowly may let the opponent activate the rook with counterplay.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What makes a second weakness useful rather than cosmetic?

ANSWER AND REASONING

It demands a different defensive resource or creates a forcing threat. A pawn that cannot be attacked is not an effective second target, even if its structure looks imperfect.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Create demands the opponent cannot satisfy with the same pieces.